

# Meeting Triage — Owner, Decision, Date

For leaving meetings with decisions, owners, and dates — without accidentally accepting work that isn't yours.

## 1 CLASSIFY THE ASK

| SITUATION                | SAY THIS                                                                       |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| My call, enough info     | ↳ "Decision is X. Reason is Y. Next step is Z."                                |
| My call, missing info    | ↳ "I need X before I can call it. I'll close by Friday."                       |
| Someone else owns it     | ↳ "That sits with Priya. I'll route it, but she owns the call."                |
| Not a decision           | ↳ "Noted. I don't think there's an action here unless something changed."      |
| Dallas-level by category | ↳ "That's a Dallas-level call by category. I'll have a doc for him by [date]." |

## 2 ZERO ORPHANS

Every item leaves the meeting with **owner + date**, or is marked not-an-action. If neither is true when the meeting ends, you own it by default. Don't accept by silence.

## 3 CAPTURE FORMAT

```
[Name] owns [thing] by [date].  
I owe [thing] by [date].  
Dallas needs: [thing / none].
```

A running RingCentral / Notes thread to yourself is enough. The format is the habit.

## 4 WHEN TO WRITE A DECISION DOC

Only for **one-way-door** or high-cost-to-reverse decisions — anything that locks eng capacity beyond a sprint, makes a customer commitment, changes a schema, or appears in a public roadmap. Everything else gets owner/date capture.

## 5 PHRASES THAT WORK (USE AS NEEDED)

**Guardrail:** Assume confusion first, politics second, malice third. Escalate only when the pattern repeats.

| WHEN YOU HEAR THIS           | SAY THIS                                                                                                    |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| New scope mid-meeting        | ↳ "What does that displace?" — or — "I can do that, but [other thing] slips. Which one's the priority?"     |
| Reopening a settled decision | ↳ "Has something changed since then?" — or — "I hear you, but the decision stands unless there's new data." |

| WHEN YOU HEAR THIS                  | SAY THIS                                                                                            |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Technical complexity as pressure    | ↳ "Walk me through the technical constraint — I want to make sure we're solving the right problem." |
| Vague problem thrown at you         | ↳ "Who owns the next step? Let's name it before we move on."                                        |
| Retroactive "you should have known" | ↳ "Given what we knew on [date], this was the call. New information would update it."               |
| You need to think before answering  | ↳ "Let me come back with something written. I want to get it right."                                |

## APPENDIX · DOOR CLASSIFICATION (WHEN YOU'RE NOT SURE)

**Two-way door (most asks).** Cheap to undo. Decide at ~70% certainty. Examples: a new report slice, a Bulk Apply button, a copy tweak that's not customer-facing.

Examples: pack-size after inventory received, tightening an override surface, build-vs-buy on payment processing, customer-facing onboarding copy.

**One-way door (rare; slow down).** Costly or impossible to undo. Decide at ≥90%, in writing.

## APPENDIX · DECISION-DOC TEMPLATE (ONE-WAY DOORS ONLY)

- 1 **Problem** — one paragraph ending in "...so we need to decide whether to \_\_\_\_."
- 2 **Options** — ≥2, with tradeoffs ("Option A buys speed at the cost of N months of catalog cleanup later"), not pros/cons.
- 3 **Recommendation + confidence %** — your call and how sure you are.
- 4 **RAPID roles** — Recommend / Agree / Perform / Input / Decide. Name people, not teams.
- 5 **Decision date** — picked in advance. Unblocks waiting parties.
- 6 **What we knew on [date]** — known, unknown, deferred. Defense against hindsight.

Sources — Bezos, 2016 Letter to Shareholders (one-way/two-way doors, 70% rule) · Brian Armstrong, How we make decisions at Coinbase (single-DRI, decision date) · Bain & Co., RAPID Decision Making · PagerDuty, The Blameless Postmortem (contemporaneous record beats hindsight narrative). Compiled 2026-05-12 for SchoolCafe 2.0 / Perseus-NXT (the B2B district-staff platform).